



Short Questions:

1. Define the Digital Divide.

The digital divide is the gap between individuals or groups who have access to information and communication technologies (ICT) and those who do not.

2. List any four causes of the digital divide.

- Lack of internet infrastructure
- High cost of devices and connectivity
- Low digital literacy
- Geographical barriers (rural vs urban areas)

3. What is meant by ICT in the workplace?

ICT in the workplace refers to the use of digital technologies like computers, internet, and communication tools to perform tasks, manage data, and improve communication.

4. Define Employee Monitoring.

Employee monitoring is the practice of tracking employees' activities at work using software or surveillance systems to ensure productivity and security.

5. Mention two benefits of ICT for employees.

- Improved communication and collaboration
- Increased efficiency and faster task completion

6. What is workplace productivity?

Workplace productivity is the measure of how efficiently employees complete tasks and produce output within a given time.

Long Questions:

1. Explain the Digital Divide and its Indicators

Digital Divide

The **digital divide** refers to the gap between individuals, communities, or countries that have access to Information and Communication Technology (ICT) and those that do not. This divide affects access to education, employment, healthcare, and government services.

Indicators of Digital Divide

Indicators help measure the extent of the digital divide:

1. Access to Devices (Computers, Smartphones)

This indicator refers to the availability of digital devices required to access technology.

- People without devices cannot use digital services
- Ownership of smartphones, laptops, or tablets varies across regions
- Rural and low-income groups often have limited access

Example: Students without smartphones cannot participate in online learning.

2. Internet Connectivity (Availability and Speed)

Internet access is a key factor in determining digital inclusion.

- Availability of internet in urban vs rural areas differs
- Slow internet speed limits effective usage
- Reliable connectivity is essential for education and business

Example: Poor network connectivity disrupts online classes and video calls.

3. Digital Literacy (Skills to Use Technology)

Digital literacy refers to the ability to use computers, software, and the internet effectively.

- Includes basic skills like typing, browsing, and using applications
- Lack of skills prevents people from using available technology
- Education and training improve digital literacy

Example: Elderly people may struggle to use online banking services.

4. Usage Levels (Frequency of Internet Use)

This measures how often and how effectively people use digital technologies.

- Some people use the internet daily, while others rarely use it
- Higher usage indicates better digital inclusion
- Limited usage may be due to lack of awareness or skills

Example: Regular users benefit more from online services than occasional users.

5. Economic Factors (Affordability of Technology)

Economic conditions play a major role in accessing digital resources.

- High cost of devices and internet plans restrict access

- Low-income groups may prioritize basic needs over technology
- Affordable technology helps reduce the digital divide

Example: Expensive data plans may prevent continuous internet usage.



Conclusion

The digital divide creates inequality and must be reduced through education, infrastructure, and affordable technology.

2. Describe ICT in the Workplace. Give Examples of its Applications

Definition

ICT in the workplace refers to the use of digital tools such as computers, software, internet, and communication systems to perform organizational tasks efficiently.

Applications of ICT

1. Communication

Emails, video conferencing, messaging apps

Example: Online meetings using Zoom/Teams

2. Data Management

Databases, cloud storage

Example: Employee records stored digitally

3. Automation

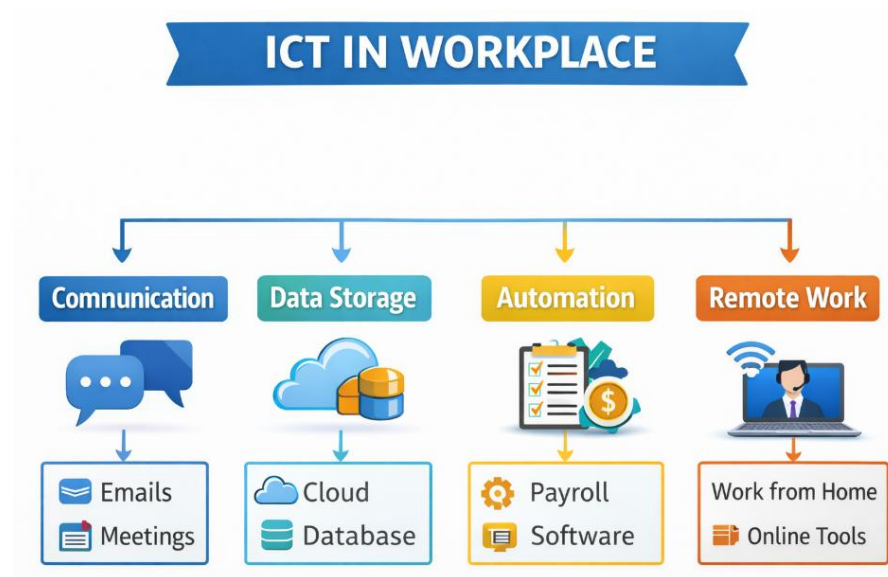
Software for payroll, billing, inventory

Example: Accounting software

4. Remote Work

Work from home using internet tools

Example: Cloud-based collaboration tools



Conclusion

ICT improves efficiency, communication, and flexibility in modern workplaces.

3. What is Employee Monitoring? Discuss its Benefits and Ethical Issues

Definition

Employee monitoring is the use of technology to track employees' activities such as internet usage, emails, attendance, and performance.

Benefits

1. Improves Productivity

Employee monitoring helps organizations track how employees use their time during work hours. By analyzing activities, companies can identify inefficiencies and improve workflow.

- Encourages employees to stay focused
- Reduces time wastage on non-work activities
- Helps in achieving organizational goals

Example: Monitoring software can track task completion time and improve efficiency.

2. Ensures Security of Data

Monitoring systems help protect sensitive company data from unauthorized access or misuse.

- Detects suspicious activities
- Prevents data leaks and cyber threats

- Protects confidential business information

Example: Alerts when an employee tries to transfer sensitive files.

3. Prevents Misuse of Resources

Companies provide resources like computers, internet, and software for work purposes. Monitoring ensures these resources are used properly.

- Prevents excessive personal use of internet
- Avoids installation of unauthorized software
- Ensures proper utilization of company assets

4. Helps Performance Evaluation

Monitoring tools provide data that can be used to evaluate employee performance fairly.

- Helps managers assess productivity levels
- Identifies high-performing and low-performing employees
- Supports decision-making for promotions or training

Ethical Issues

1. Privacy Violation

Continuous monitoring may invade employees' personal space and privacy.

- Employees may feel constantly watched
- Personal communications may be exposed

2. Lack of Trust

Excessive monitoring can create a feeling that the employer does not trust employees.

- Reduces employee morale
- May damage employer-employee relationships

3. Employee Stress

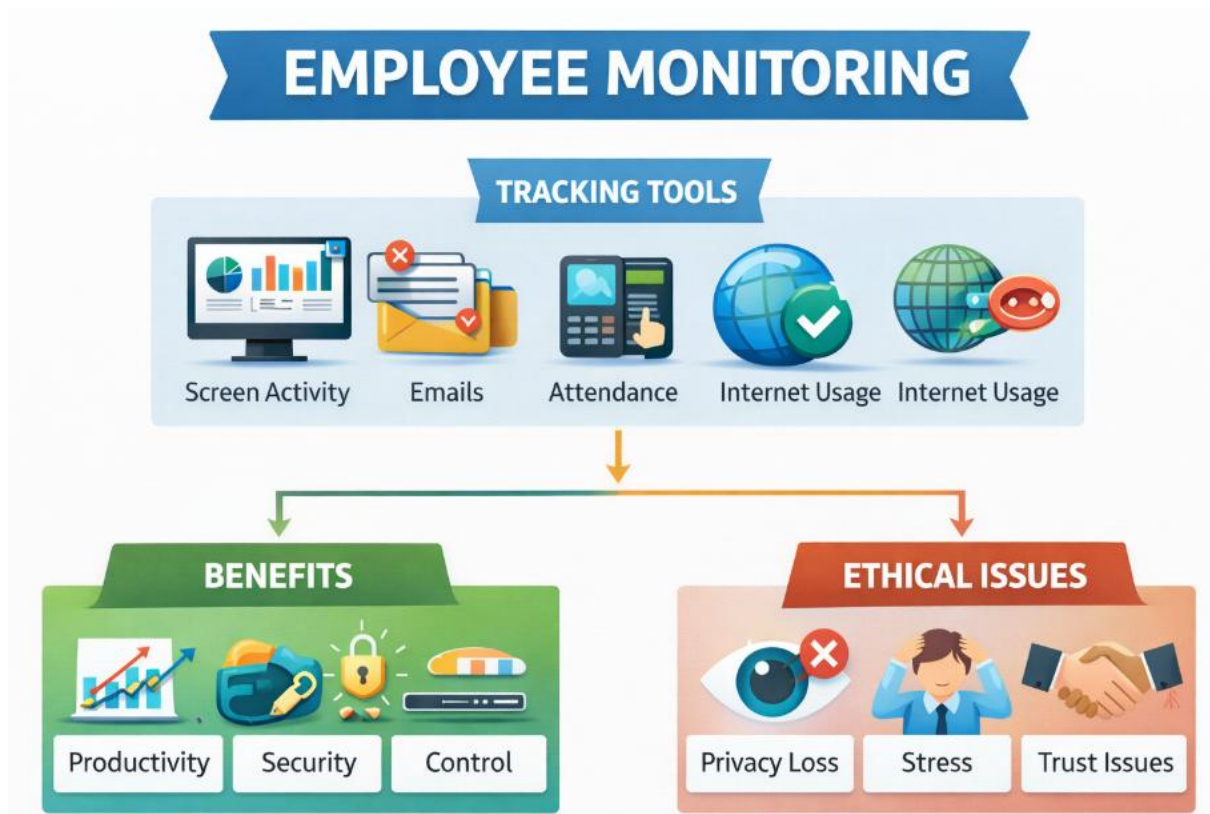
Being constantly monitored can increase pressure and anxiety among employees.

- Fear of being judged at all times
- Can lead to reduced job satisfaction

4. Data Misuse Risks

Collected monitoring data can be misused if not handled properly.

- Risk of unauthorized access to employee data
- Potential misuse for unfair decisions



Conclusion

Employee monitoring should be balanced to protect both organizational interests and employee rights.

4. Discuss the Social Impact of Computing Technologies on Modern Society

Positive Impacts

1. Improved Communication

Computing technologies have made communication faster, easier, and more efficient. People can instantly connect with others across the world using emails, messaging apps, and social media platforms.

- Instant messaging and video calls save time and cost
- Enables global collaboration in businesses and education
- Social media helps in sharing information quickly

Example: Online meetings and chats allow employees to work remotely.

2. Access to Information

The internet provides unlimited access to information and knowledge. Students, professionals, and researchers can easily find data, learn new skills, and stay updated.

- Online education platforms and e-learning tools
- Digital libraries and research databases
- Easy access to news and global information

Example: Students can attend online classes and access study materials anytime.

3. Economic Growth

Computing has contributed significantly to economic development by creating new business opportunities and jobs.

- Growth of e-commerce and online businesses
- Creation of IT jobs and digital careers
- Increased productivity and efficiency in industries

Example: Online shopping platforms allow businesses to reach global customers.

4. Healthcare Improvements

Technology has improved healthcare services and patient care.

- Telemedicine allows remote consultation with doctors
- Digital records help in better patient management
- Advanced medical equipment improves diagnosis and treatment

Example: Patients can consult doctors online without visiting hospitals.

Negative Impacts

1. Digital Divide

Not everyone has equal access to digital technologies. This creates inequality in education, employment, and social opportunities.

- Rural and poor communities often lack access
- Leads to social and economic imbalance

2. Privacy Concerns

Personal information stored online can be misused or accessed without permission.

- Data breaches and identity theft risks
- Misuse of personal data by companies

3. Cybercrime

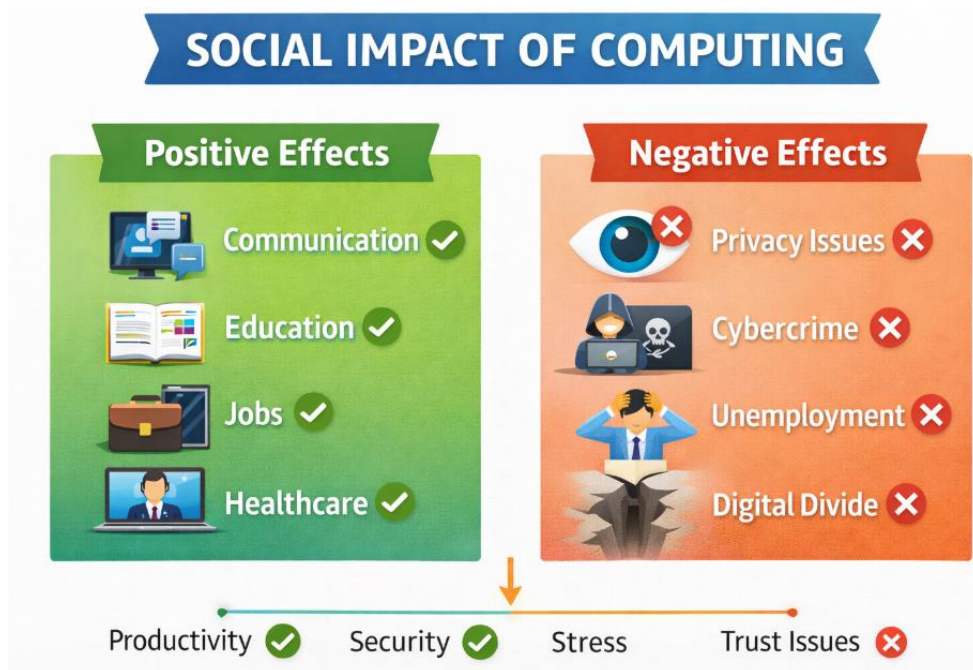
The rise of digital systems has increased cybercrimes such as hacking and online fraud.

- Financial losses and data theft
- Threats to individuals and organizations

4. Job Displacement due to Automation

Automation reduces the need for human labor in many industries.

- Machines replace repetitive jobs
- Unemployment in certain sectors



Conclusion

Computing technologies have transformed society significantly, offering many benefits but also creating challenges that must be managed responsibly.